

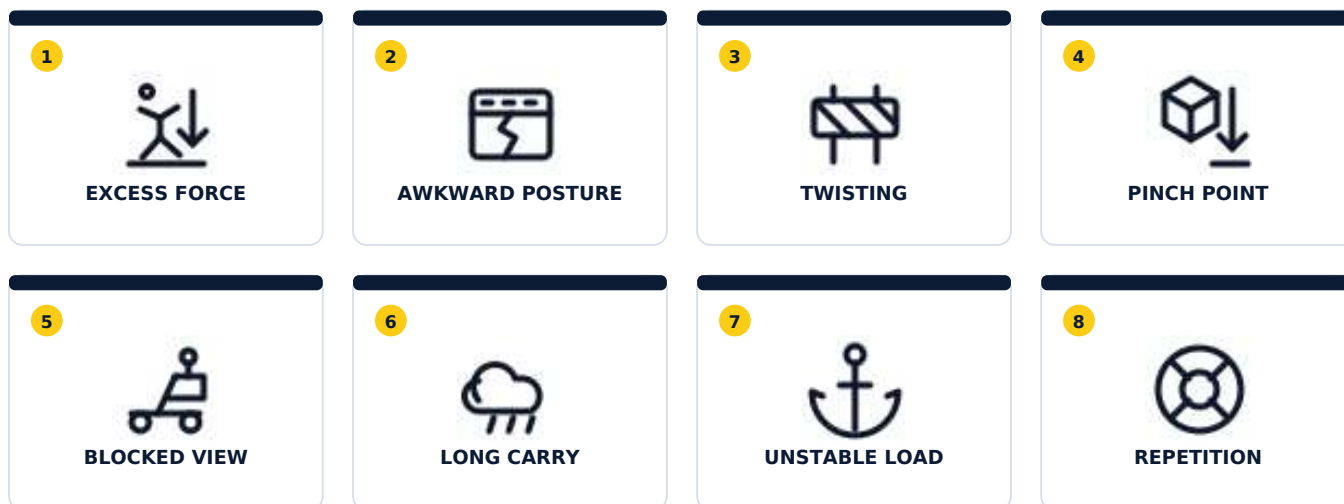
MANUAL HANDLING AND ERGONOMICS

Assess loads correctly, lift safely and prevent unnecessary strain.

PURPOSE AND SCOPE

Prevent back, shoulder, hand and musculoskeletal injuries during manual handling by assessing the load, work area and individual capacity before starting. Manual handling includes lifting, lowering, carrying, pushing, pulling, holding and repetitive movements.

KEY HAZARDS



CRITICAL VALUES TO VERIFY IN THE FIELD

100%

Load, route and set-down check

Mechanical aid

First choice

Neutral posture

Load kept close



REMEMBER - SERNEM

S

Stop and think

E

Evaluate the risk

R

Remove or reduce

N

Never assume

E

Ensure protection

M

Monitor and communicate

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STANDARDS AND FIELD REQUIREMENTS

OSHA sets no universal kilogram limit. OSHA 1910.176, the NIOSH RNLE and ISO 11228-1 guidance support task redesign and mechanical assistance first.

OSHA 1910.176(a) SAFE CLEARANCE

Provide sufficient clearance and safe passage in aisles and loading areas where mechanical handling equipment is used.

OSHA 1910.176(b) SECURE STORAGE

Store materials securely and accessibly so they cannot slide, fall or collapse.

NIOSH RNLE LIFTING ASSESSMENT

Assess horizontal reach, height, twisting, frequency and coupling together with load weight.

ISO 11228-1 TASK DESIGN

Redesign lifting, lowering and carrying using handling aids, suitable work height and exposure duration.

MINIMUM EVIDENCE BEFORE START

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Task-specific ergonomic assessment | ☐ Load weight and center of gravity |
| ☐ Travel-route inspection | ☐ Mechanical-aid inspection |
| ☐ Team-lift briefing | ☐ Training and early-reporting record |

SUPERVISOR DISCUSSION POINTS

- Can you safely control this load alone?
- Where is the load's centre of gravity?
- Is the carrying route clear?

CONTROLLED MATERIAL HANDLING WITH A MECHANICAL AID



Plan - Clear route - Adjustable height - Neutral posture - Controlled guidance



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CRITICAL CONTROL MEASURES (HIERARCHY OF CONTROLS)

1. ELIMINATE MANUAL LIFTING

Assess the load's weight, size, shape and grip points. Use mechanical lifting and transport equipment wherever possible.

2. USE MECHANICAL ASSISTANCE

Inspect and clear the carrying route before starting. Use team lifting where required and appoint one person to coordinate. Keep the load close to the body and avoid sudden movements.

3. REDESIGN THE LOAD / TASK

Wear suitable gloves and safety footwear. Do not lift loads beyond your safe capacity or control. Do not lift loads beyond your safe capacity or control.

4. PLAN TEAM, TECHNIQUE AND RECOVERY

Do not lift loads beyond your safe capacity or control. Do not lift loads beyond your safe capacity or control.

CRITICAL WARNING



['Assess the load and centre of gravity before lifting.', 'Keep a stable stance and hold the load close to your body.', 'Bend your knees instead of bending from the waist.', 'Turn with your feet instead of twisting your torso.', 'Asking for assistance is the correct safety decision.']

SITE CHECKLIST (BEFORE STARTING WORK)

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ The load and handling method have been | ☐ The carrying route is clear. |
| ☐ Required mechanical aids are available. | ☐ Team-lifting roles are agreed where required. |
| ☐ Suitable PPE is being used. | |

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ATTENDANCE AND APPROVAL

Project / Site: _____ Date: _____

Presented by: _____ Work area: _____

No	Full Name	Company / Role	Signature
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
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9			
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11			
12			